



Samuel “Shmoo” Bigus

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Work authorization: U.S. citizen; currently engages with studios worldwide on a B2B/contract basis. EU (German) citizenship expected within the next few months, which will add full EU work authorization without employer sponsorship.

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Game producer with two years of dedicated production leadership across four shipped-or-shipping Steam titles, preceded by six years of freelance project and client management. Has planned publisher milestones up to four months out without missing, led a full Jira-to-ClickUp tooling migration for a 17-person team, and doubled in-game sales in six weeks by shipping backlog items chosen directly from player metrics. Builds original production tooling tailored for optimal team pipelines.

CORE SKILLS

Production & Agile: Scrum, sprint planning, backlog & risk management, Kanban, production scheduling, long-range milestone planning, team scaling & onboarding, outsourcing/vendor management, publisher relations

Tools & Platforms: Jira, ClickUp, PostHog, GameAnalytics, Notion, Miro

EXPERIENCE

Producer — Abyssal Guardians, Smoothie Studio Warsaw, Poland (remote team) | May 2026 – Present

Team grown from 5 to 7

- Rebuilt the studio's task and scheduling structure around two-week production cycles
- Grew the founding team from five to seven, onboarding all new hires
- Manages a rotating roster of freelance artists and audio contractors
- Sourced an audio designer now regarded internally as an outstanding fit
- Supporting public reveal and marketing kickoff

Producer — Cowboy Life Simulator, Odd Qubit / RockGame S.A. Remote | Apr 2026 – Jun 2026

Team of 17

- Planned work up to four months ahead against publisher milestones — hit every one
- Grew the team from 10 to 17, onboarding all interns new hires
- Led the full task-tracker migration from Jira to ClickUp for a 17-person team, cutting tooling cost
- Supports a live title holding a “Very Positive” Steam rating across 1,000+ reviews
- Scouted voice-acting talent for the production

Producer Intern — Whimpy!, Level Headed Games Remote | Jan 2026 – Mar 2026

Team of 5

- Set project direction directly with the studio CEO
- Ran three structured playtests that shaped pre-launch priorities
- Supported Steam launch preparation for a new multiplayer title

Producer & Designer — Poly Plaza, The Poly Plaza Company Remote | Jan 2025 – Jul 2025

Team of 2

- Doubled sales in six weeks by shipping backlog items chosen directly from player metrics
- Ran milestone tracking and investor/stakeholder communication solo alongside one other person
- Designed the stock-trading and home-upgrade systems
- Wrote quest content

Creative Developer & Game Designer / Scrum Master — Make a Friend Remote | Oct 2024 – Jan 2025

Team of 4

- Led early-stage product design for a turn-based RPG and companion chat app
- Integrated AI tooling into the team's production workflow

Product Designer & Developer — Freelance Remote | 2020 – Present

- Runs an ongoing web/product design practice (Figma, React, Tailwind)
- Delivers client engagements on Scrum/Kanban, on time and on budget

Floor Supervisor & Multi-Role Coordinator — UPS Gardner, KS, USA | 2018 – 2019

Team of 5+

- Coordinated Safety, Training, and IT functions for a warehouse team

GAME JAMS

Lead — Wastemancer (game jam) Remote — international team (Poland, Sweden, China) | 3-week jam

Team of 12

- Directed a cross-timezone, international team to deliver a complete competitive game in three weeks using Notion, Jira, and Miro

Lead, Art Production — Necromeowcy (game jam) Remote | 7-day jam

Team of 13

- Ran the art pipeline and team coordination for a city-builder under jam time pressure

PRODUCER TOOLING & INITIATIVES

- Built an AI-assisted producer pipeline: voice-recorded meeting capture → automated transcription → AI-generated bug reports feeding directly into the team's ClickUp board
- Built a milestone-health digest tool for cross-project status reporting

EDUCATION

Game Producer Program — FutureGames Warsaw, Poland | 2025 – 2026

Industry partner: CD Projekt Red

- Coursework in game production tools & methodologies, product management, and business intelligence for game studios
- Built and shipped three team-based game projects under studio-style production constraints
- Studied game dynamics, leadership, and team communication, including coaching and stakeholder-facing communication

B.A., Orchestral Instrumentation — University of Kansas Kansas, USA | 2010 – 2015

- Group Leadership
- Coaching 1 on 1